Massena Town Board
Massena, NY 13662

ZeroC Data Centers LLC
417 Massena Center Rd
Massena, NY 13662

Summary of Comments

The following summary addresses the comments from the public hearing for amending the zoning law to include data centers, held on January 21st, 2026.

- **Water pollution**
  - Early on, data center vendors were indeed asking for an immense amount of water for cooling; sometimes on the order of 2000 GPM. This could only have been achieved by pulling water from the Grasse or St Lawrence rivers. Over the last 12 months however, the requirement has changed and data centers no longer require this type of water supply as they use closed loop evaporative cooling.
  - **Concession**: *Since this is now the standard, we have no issue if the local law requires closed loop cooling designs. If there was a need to deviate from this design, the data center vendor could apply for a variance, but this is extremely unlikely. As you know, the DEC has very strict requirements and permitting for water usage, so language deferring to the DEC to enforce water use may be helpful as this is the case anyhow.*
- **CO^2 Emissions**
  - This was clearly another huge misconception of attendees. There is essentially one reason that data centers are willing to build so far from urban and suburban regions, and this is of course low cost, renewable hydroelectric power. This is the local natural resource that the community is blessed with. There are several data center vendors still intent on carbon neutrality and a strong preference for renewable power. Data centers have two options left in the US until new technology nuclear power is available. One is to build cogeneration plants alongside their data centers in the middle of Texas. The other is to find pockets of renewable energy with enough of a fiber optic footprint. The first option of course does generate CO^2 and is the most common scenario in the US.

- **Concession**: *If the law stipulates that there can be no carbon based power generation onsite, this will have no impact on data centers looking to build here. Again, the DEC has very strict rules regarding emissions. We've had these discussions as well, so beyond backup power, which given the stability of power in the area, is not impactful, data centers have no such aspirations here.*

- **Targeting Poverty Stricken Areas**
  - It's not clear what the origin of this claim is. Once again, the sole reason for building in the area is the existing and abandoned hydroelectric power, with the cool environment being a small bonus. Although there are existing crypto data centers here already, a real Level 3 AI data center employee has an average annual salary of $90,000. We have no Level 3 data center in the community as of yet, but these are precisely the type of data centers that would be built here. To compare to crypto, it costs about $300,000 per MW to build a crypto data center. It costs $11,000,000 per MW to build a Level 3 AI data center. Salaries tend to be commensurate.
- **More Crypto, Waste of Energy Claim**
  - This is a broad, subjective topic but the salient point here is that most if not all crypto mines will shut down this year or latest next year as it becomes less and less economically viable and Bitcoin nears its mining horizon.
  - **Concession:** *It's meaningless to data centers interested in building here, so adding clarification for "non-crypto" data centers is of no consequence and apparently overridden by existing local law anyhow.*
- **Short Term, Five Year Industry Claim**
  - Given the amount of investment, this is of course absurd but probably a misunderstanding of the cyclic upgrade of chips. Every 3 to 5 years, AI data centers will upgrade their chip sets to a more efficient version, generating additional cyclic sales tax and minor construction. Data center vendors are looking for 20 to 30 year power contracts at minimum. We've had direct discussions with Google, Microsoft, Meta, Core Scientific and over a dozen data center EPCs on this point.
- **Increasing Local Rates**
  - The point was well made at the hearing, but it's worth repeating that the power comes from different circuits than those powering Massena. More than a gigawatt of power previously used by the local industry was abandoned.
- **Legacy Cleanup and Health Impacts**

- Needless to say, it would be untenable to burden inbound industry with cleaning up after the previous one. That being said, the legacy impacts on the Akwesasne from previous aluminum industry seems genuine if not predictable based on the super sites.
- **Concession**: *At the tariff level, it's not unreasonable to have "2 mills" (2 tenths of a cent) added to the cost of power for data centers. The power is comparably cheap to most regions other than Texas which is our closest competitor at this point. This should translate to more than $10,000,000 to $20,000,000 per year in revenue for the community. This of course could be designated, as determined by the town board, for improved healthcare, clinic construction or even local cleanup efforts managed by the Akwesasne. As the ultimate off-takers are credit worthy, bankable institutions, it's reasonable to be able to service debt on projects in the $200 to $300 million range.*

Conclusion

We plan to meet with Chief Lazore of the Akwesasne (unless you advise us not to) to address the misinformation and common misconceptions of what modern data centers entail. Based on the health and environment impacts endured in the past, it's hard to imagine any other type of industry that would be safer for their community. We've invited North Country to join us in that discussion.

In addition, we are planning a field trip to a modern, efficient data center site to hopefully further allay any fears and hopefully further inform the community. Perhaps a dozen community members from Massena and the Akwesasne. We would provide travel and accommodations and a guided tour.

It's worth noting that the doctor that spoke at the hearing cited the community in Montreal as having much better health comparably. We've spoken with Vantage data centers which operate multiple large scale data centers in Montreal with no apparent health risks by their own admission, so this comparison is a helpful one.

The economic benefits for the Akwesasne and the Massena community are self-evident so we won't address them here.